

Tamil Development, Information and Publicity Department

Detailed Profile: Department & Minister-in-Charge A. Rajmohan (Rajmohan Arumugam)

PART A — The Department

A.1 Origins and Structure

The Tamil Development, Information and Publicity Department is one of the functional departments of the Government of Tamil Nadu, headquartered in Chennai. Its printing and stationery function dates back to 1831, making it one of the oldest continuously running administrative arms of the state government. Over time it was expanded to combine language development, public communication, and government printing under a single administrative umbrella.

It comprises three principal directorates:

- **Directorate of Tamil Development** – promotes and safeguards the Tamil language, monitors implementation of Tamil as the official language in government offices, and inspects district/taluk-level Tamil Development offices for compliance (tour programmes, registers, notice boards, correspondence, etc. are reviewed during inspections).
- **Directorate of Information and Publicity** – the state's public-relations arm; manages press releases, government advertising, publicity campaigns for welfare schemes, and liaison with print/broadcast media.
- **Directorate of Stationery and Printing** – runs the Government Press and handles printing and stationery supply for all state departments.

A.2 Full Subject Portfolio

Beyond the three directorates, the department's notified subject list (as held by the current minister) includes: Tamil Official Language and Tamil Culture; Information & Publicity; Film Technology and the Cinematograph Act (regulation of cinema-related matters in the state); Newsprint Control; Stationery and Printing; and the Government Press.

A.3 Administrative Setup

Aspect	Detail
Headquarters	Chennai, Tamil Nadu
Parent body	Government of Tamil Nadu
Directorates	Tamil Development; Information & Publicity; Stationery & Printing
Field-level structure	State, district, and taluk/block-level Tamil Development offices carrying out inspections and of
Core functions	Language promotion, government publicity/PR, government printing, film-related regulatory m

PART B — Minister-in-Charge: A. Rajmohan (Rajmohan Arumugam)

B.1 Overview

Rajmohan Arumugam — widely known by his popular nickname **“Put Chutney” Rajmohan** — is an Indian entertainer-turned-politician from Chennai who currently serves as Tamil Nadu's **Minister for School Education** and **Minister for Tamil Development and Information** in the cabinet of Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay. He represents the Egmore constituency in the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly as a member of the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), the party founded by actor C. Joseph Vijay.

B.2 Personal & Career Background

Before entering politics, Rajmohan built a long career in entertainment and digital media spanning nearly two decades:

- Trained as an engineering graduate and briefly worked as a radio jockey before shifting to television and digital content.
- Won the second season of the Star Vijay TV oratory/talent show *Tamil Pechu Engal Moochu*, which gave him wider public recognition.
- Served as channel director of the popular YouTube channel **“Put Chutney”** and founded its sister channel **“Tamil Vannakam”**, producing comedy and socially themed content that built a large, youth-heavy following.
- Worked as an actor in Tamil cinema, with supporting roles in films including *Natpe Thunai*, *VIP 2*, *Ispade Rajavum Ithayaraniyum*, *Thaana Serntha Koottam*, and *Nenjamundu Nermaiundu Odu Raja*.
- Also worked as a stand-up comedian, television anchor, motivational speaker, orator, writer and director, and had begun work on a directorial debut film.

He subsequently became the **Propaganda Secretary** of the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), acting as a key campaign speaker for the party ahead of the 2026 Tamil Nadu Assembly election.

B.3 Election to the Assembly

Constituency	Egmore (Chennai district, SC-reserved seat)
Party	Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK)
Result	Elected, 2026 Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly election
Votes secured	53,901 votes (per candidate affidavit records)
Predecessor	I. Paranthamen (DMK), who had held the seat since 2021
Declared self-profession	Media presenter / YouTube channel owner
Declared education (affidavit)	B.A. (Journalism and Mass Communication), Madurai Kamaraj University, 2018; Diploma in Journalism, 2019
Criminal cases declared	None, per publicly available affidavit records

Note: Affidavit-based figures are self-declared by the candidate to the Election Commission and are reproduced here from publicly available election-watch archives; they are not independently verified by this document.

B.4 Ministerial Role

Assumed office (MLA)	4 May 2026
Assumed office (Minister)	10 May 2026
Chief Minister	C. Joseph Vijay
Governor	R. V. Arlekar

Departments held	School Education; Tamil Development and Information
Cabinet context	Part of the first-ever TVK council of ministers, formed after the party's debut win in the 202

B.5 Actions and Statements in Office

- **Two-language policy / NEP-NEET stance:** While launching the 2026-27 academic year admission drive at a Chennai school, Rajmohan reaffirmed that Tamil Nadu's long-standing two-language policy would continue unchanged, and stated that the state's existing education policy was sufficient, reiterating opposition to the National Education Policy (NEP) and NEET.
- **Religious symbols in schools – statement and reversal:** He initially stated that students displaying religious symbols would not be allowed on educational campuses. Following strong public backlash and criticism from Hindu organisations, he retracted and clarified there would be no such ban, noting he himself used to wear sacred ash and kumkum as a student.
- **Department consultations:** Held early consultative meetings with School Education and Tamil Development officials shortly after taking charge, and reviewed the student admission process in Chennai schools in person.
- **Educational-qualification scrutiny:** His own academic credentials attracted questions on social media and in regional press/video coverage shortly after his appointment, with critics contrasting affidavit-declared qualifications against public claims. This remained a media talking point without a confirmed formal/legal outcome as of the most recent available reports.

B.6 Political Context

The 2026 Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly election was the debut electoral contest for the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), founded by actor C. Joseph Vijay. The party secured an absolute majority (108 of 234 seats on its own, with allied seats taking the coalition past the majority mark), ending the prior DMK-led government of M. K. Stalin. Vijay was sworn in as Chief Minister at the Jawaharlal Nehru Indoor Stadium in Chennai, and Rajmohan is one of several entertainment-industry figures — alongside Vijay himself — who transitioned into this cabinet. Cabinet portfolios were formally notified via government order shortly after the ministry was sworn in.

Note: This document compiles publicly reported information as of August 2026, drawn from news coverage, election-watch archives (affidavit data), and general reference sources. Details of a very recently formed government — portfolios, statements, and ongoing controversies — can change quickly and some figures (e.g. self-declared affidavit data) are not independently verified. Please cross-check against the official Government of Tamil Nadu portal (tn.gov.in) and the Election Commission of India before formal or official use.